

health STRESS

WHEN CEOS GET *THE BLUES*

Indian CEOs work the hardest and, barring China, are most stressed out globally, shows new research. Being the big man on top leaves no more room for joy and opens the door to stress and tension.



■ By Damayanti Datta

If a nation creates new heroes every now and then, CEOs are the dazzling people who symbolise India's emergence as a global economic power. They earn eight-figure salaries and know how to spend those, too. But money, fame or power clearly do not buy happiness. According to new research, Indian CEOs aren't just working longer hours, they are holding down extreme jobs—logging 60-plus hours a week, enduring 24x7 demands, facing severe global business competition, tighter-than-ever deadlines and unpredictable work-flows. Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw, head honcho of Biocon Limited, is not surprised: “Globalisation has put an intense pressure on CEOs to perform and acquire global footprints. Indian CEOs fare no better.” No wonder, in a 2006 global CEO survey by *The Economist*, 54 per cent claimed they would not want the CEO posi-

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	Hours/week	Stress%
 India	57	79
 China	54	84
 Japan	50	50
 US	55	43
 UK	49	37
Global Average	53	56

Source: Grant Thornton International Business Report, 2007